

# Diabetes Mellitus - Educational Overview

*Educational summary aligned with widely published WHO/public-health diabetes themes (not a substitute for WHO documents or medical care).*

## What is diabetes?

Diabetes mellitus is a chronic condition marked by high blood glucose. It occurs when the body does not make enough insulin (commonly type 1) or cannot use insulin effectively (commonly type 2). Gestational diabetes can appear during pregnancy. Uncontrolled high glucose over time can damage vessels, nerves, kidneys, eyes, and the heart.

## Common symptoms

Symptoms can include increased thirst, frequent urination, unexplained weight change, fatigue, blurred vision, slow-healing sores, and recurrent infections. Some people with type 2 diabetes have few early symptoms, so screening matters for at-risk adults.

## Risk factors and prevention focus

Type 2 risk rises with overweight/obesity, physical inactivity, older age, family history, and certain cardiometabolic conditions. Helpful prevention themes include balanced diet, activity, healthy weight, tobacco avoidance, and regular checkups. Type 1 is autoimmune and not prevented by lifestyle alone.

## Management themes

Management may combine glucose monitoring, nutrition, physical activity, medicines (including insulin when needed), blood-pressure and cholesterol care, foot checks, and eye exams. Individual plans must come from qualified clinicians.